WCF-001 // SEALED SOLUTION

The Last Course

Open only after recording your accusation

CULPRIT: NOLAN REED, STATION 4

The conclusion

Nolan Reed deliberately contaminated Simone Vale's red-banded tasting spoon with a mixture containing peanut protein and orange-blossom finishing oil. He then concealed her epinephrine auto-injector in the laundry hamper. His goal was to prevent Simone from exposing his theft of Luc Moreau's unpublished croquant formula.

The decisive chain

Step	Evidence	What it proves
1	All four desserts and the other judges' spoons tested negative for peanut protein.	The attack was directed at Simone's spoon, not delivered through a dessert.
2	The red spoon and discarded pipette contain both peanut protein and orange-blossom finishing oil.	The pipette carried the same unusual contaminating mixture applied to Simone's spoon.
3	The school's only orange-blossom bottle, F-17, was returned sealed.	Nolan lied when he said he used the school bottle. The mixture came from another container.
4	Nolan's personal carrier lost 48 grams, yet all three photographed croquant pieces remained intact and no broken décor was found.	An undeclared object left Nolan's carrier during the exam.
5	The empty channel in the carrier fits a narrow vial; one shared pipette is missing and later appears cleanly on top of relocated Station 2 waste.	The missing object was consistent with a vial, and the contaminated pipette was discarded after Caleb's own waste had accumulated.
6	Nolan had an authorized turn at the pass, where Plate D and the hamper blocked the proctor's view of Simone's kit.	He had the opportunity to treat the spoon and conceal the auto-injector.
7	Simone's email and calendar note show she planned to report Nolan for copying Moreau's unpublished formula.	Nolan had an immediate motive to silence her before she contacted the apprenticeship committee.

No single clue completes the accusation. The sealed bottle exposes Nolan's false statement; the carrier weight and photographs establish an undeclared missing object; the laboratory result links that object's likely contents to the contaminated pipette and spoon; the pass layout supplies opportunity; and Simone's records establish motive.

Why the other finalists are not responsible

Lena Ortiz

Lena initially concealed a real violation: she tasted Caleb's cherry gel with her issued brush. The photographs and issue record account for that brush at Station 1, and neither her property weight nor her ingredients indicate an undeclared liquid. Her lie explains her suspicious behavior but does not fit the contaminant evidence.

Caleb Moss

Caleb touched the red spoon with tongs and moved his waste caddy, making him an effective false lead. But the contaminated pipette was found on top of his existing cherry-stained waste after the caddy had been relocated within reach of three stations. The pipette contains orange-blossom oil, while Caleb's issued liquid was cherry concentrate. Its location cannot identify its user.

Priya Shah

Priya handled the scorecards and worked with a declared almond ingredient, but her plated dessert and ingredient container tested negative for peanut. She had no unexplained property loss and no connection to the orange-blossom mixture. Her plate position is suspicious only because Simone began tasting there.

Nolan's false explanations

- He said he used and returned an empty school bottle. F-17 remained sealed.
- He blamed the carrier's 48-gram loss on broken décor. The same three intact pieces appear before and after, and no broken décor was recovered.
- He denied using a pipette. The shared box is missing one, and that pipette carries the same two-part residue found on Simone's spoon.
- He denied approaching the hamper. The layout shows that his authorized position provided the best concealed access to both the spoon and hamper.

Reconstructed sequence

Time	Action
Previous evening	After receiving Simone's email, Nolan prepares a small vial containing peanut-derived oil and orange-blossom finishing oil.
8:15	Simone confronts Nolan. He denies copying; she decides to notify Moreau and the apprenticeship committee after the

Time	Action
	exam.
Before 10:30	Nolan keeps the vial concealed in the narrow channel inside his sugar décor carrier.
10:42	During his authorized garnish turn at Plate D, Nolan removes the vial from his carrier, uses a shared pipette to treat Simone's red-banded spoon, and slips the vial into his chef-coat pocket.
10:42 to 10:43	Shielded by the hamper, Nolan removes the auto-injector and pushes it beneath the used linens.
After 10:43	He discards the pipette on top of Caleb's relocated waste and returns to Station 4.
10:46	Simone uses the contaminated spoon and suffers anaphylaxis.